# Assignment 1: Rapid Prototyping

**Due** Week 2 at the start of class.

**Goal** Accelerate through the entire design process in one assignment and explore Claude Code.

## Overview

Goal: Build 25 web landing page iterations that tell the story of the design process and 1 gallery page to explore them all.

## Steps

1. **Start with an idea.** Pick a web page you want to build — a portfolio, a very simple 1 page side project, a product, a community site, anything. This is your starting point.
2. **Build your gallery page.** Create an index.html to organize your designs. A page that will hold each landing page you create and tell the story of your process.
3. **Go wide.** Explore radically different landing pages for your idea. Different layouts, moods, visual styles, audiences, tones. What does your portfolio look like as a magazine editorial? As a brutalist manifesto? As a calm, minimal single-column page? Push the concept in directions that surprise you.
4. **Narrow down.** As you go, you'll notice which directions resonate with you. Start iterating on those. Take the typography from v5 and combine it with the layout from v11. Your landing pages should start converging — a funnel of options guided by your creative decisions. v20 - v25 should start to look similar with modifications to refinements until you feel v25 is the right option.

This is an exercise in **imagination, iteration, and speed** — an acceleration through the design process that normally takes months, compressed into days because Claude Code lets you prototype any idea in minutes.

## Tech Stack

Pure HTML and CSS. Put the code on GitHub and deploy on a free Vercel plan. No frameworks, external APIs, data persistence. Remove as many technical barriers as possible and push back on Claude if it tries to convince you to integrate other technologies.

# Submission

## Deliverables

**1. Vercel URL** — A live link to your gallery page.

**2. GitHub URL** — Public repository with commit history.

**3. Reflection Questions**

1. What files make up your site and what does each one do?
2. Describe the pipeline: what happens from git push to your site updating on Vercel?
3. Justify v25—after your entire exploration, why did you land on this version?

## Example Submission

```
https://my-site.vercel.app
https://github.com/username/my-site

1. <answer to question 1>
2. <answer to question 2>
3. <answer to question 3>
```

# Assessment

A complete assignment has:

- ☐ A live Vercel URL that works
- ☐ 1 gallery page that tells the story of your process and presents your final choice
- ☐ 25 distinct landing pages (HTML + CSS)
- ☐ A GitHub repo with multiple commits showing iteration
- ☐ Thoughtful answers to the 3 reflection questions

You won't be assessed on visual polish. You'll be assessed on **breadth of exploration, thoughtfulness of your narrative, and engament with the process**.

# Notes

Commit and push as you go — it lets you rollback when needed. Having Claude do the commits speeds things up.

# Explore Claude Code

**CLAUDE.md** — Create one in your project root with what you're building and style preferences.

**Plan mode** — Shift+Tab to plan before building. Read the plan, then let Claude build.

**Prompting** — Try vague vs. specific prompts. Iterate: "bolder typography," "more whitespace."

**Screenshots** — Paste a screenshot of a site you love and say "make something inspired by this."

**Commands** — /context · /compact · /clear · /diff · Esc Esc (undo) - https://code.claude.com/docs/en/commands

Questions? Reach out on Slack.